

Absolutely — **flatter** is a strong polysemy/family target because your passage uses it here:

> “It was **flattering** to know that something I had created in my bedroom could make so many strangers laugh.”

Here **flattering** means **making the writer feel pleased and valued because other people reacted positively to something they created**.

Word family: **flatter / flattered / flattering / flatteringly / flattery**

Base verb: flatter

Adjective/participle: flattered

Adjective: flattering

Adverb: flatteringly

Noun: flattery

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Major domains:

- * praise and social interaction
- * insincere praise
- * self-esteem / validation
- * appearance
- * clothing / fashion
- * photography / lighting
- * statistics / data presentation
- * fixed expressions such as **flatter yourself**

Meaning in your passage: **flattering = making someone feel pleased because they are being admired or appreciated** — 令人感到受肯定的；令人受寵若驚的

Your sentence:

> “It was **flattering** to know that something I had created in my bedroom could make so many strangers laugh.”

Here **flattering** means:

> **pleasantly boosting the writer’s sense of self-worth because many strangers enjoyed and appreciated something they had created.**

繁體中文：

因別人欣賞、稱讚或重視自己 / 自己的作品，而令人感到高興、受肯定或受寵若驚的

Natural translation:

> 「知道自己在房間裡創作的東西竟然能令這麼多陌生人發笑，這種感覺確實**令人很受肯定 / 有點受寵若驚**。」

So here:

> **flattering = 別人的正面反應令自己感到被欣賞、被肯定**

A. PRAISE SOMEONE

1. **flatter someone = praise someone, often to make them feel good — 稱讚某人；奉承某人**

The broad core verb meaning.

Practice 1

> “He **flattered** her by praising her presentation.”

「他稱讚她的簡報，令她感到很高興。」

Practice 2

> “She knew he was trying to flatter her.”

「她知道他是在**奉承她**。」

flatter someone = 對某人說好聽的話，使對方感到高興、重要或被欣賞

Important:

The praise may be:

- * sincere
- * exaggerated
- * strategic
- * insincere

Context decides.

B. FLATTERY AS INSINCERE PRAISE

2. **flatter = give excessive or insincere praise — 奉承；拍馬屁**

A major and very common sense.

Practice 3

> “He **flattered** the manager to get what he wanted.”

「他為了得到自己想要的東西而**奉承經理**。」

Practice 4

> “Don’t flatter me just because you need a favour.”

「不要因為想我幫忙就來**奉承我**。」

flatter = 為討好對方、取得好處或建立好感而給予過分 / 不真誠的讚美

3. **flattery** = excessive or insincere praise — 奉承；恭維；阿諛

Practice 5

> “He tried to win her over with **flattery**.”

「他試圖用**奉承話**討好她。」

Practice 6

> “She is not easily influenced by flattery.”

「她不容易受**奉承**影響。」

flattery = 讓人高興、但往往帶誇張或討好成分的讚美

C. SINCERE PRAISE THAT PLEASES SOMEONE

4. **flatter someone** = make someone feel honoured/pleased by praise — 令某人感到受寵若驚；令某人感到受肯定

Not all flattering language is necessarily manipulative.

Practice 7

> “Your invitation ****flatters**** me.”

「你的邀請令我感到****很受寵若驚****。」

Practice 8

> “The attention clearly flattered him.”

「這些關注明顯令他感到****很受肯定****。」

****flatter = 因別人的重視 / 欣賞而令某人感到高興和受到肯定****

This is close to your source.

D. BE FLATTERED

5. **be flattered = feel pleased because someone admires or values you — 感到受寵若驚；感到很受肯定**

A very important construction.

Practice 9

> “I was ****flattered**** by the compliment.”

「這句稱讚令我感到****很受寵若驚****。」

Practice 10

> “She was flattered that they had asked for her advice.”

「他們竟然向她請教，令她感到****很受重視 / 受寵若驚****。」

****be flattered = 因別人給予讚賞、關注、邀請或重視而感到高興****

6. **be flattered by + noun = 因.....而感到受寵若驚**

Practice 11

> “He was ****flattered by**** the attention.”

「這些關注令他感到****受寵若驚****。」

Practice 12

> “She was flattered by their praise.”

「他們的讚美令她感到**很受肯定**。」

7. **be flattered that + clause = 因.....而感到受寵若驚**

Practice 13

> “I’m **flattered that** you remembered my work.”

「你竟然記得我的作品，我感到**很受寵若驚**。」

Practice 14

> “She was flattered that so many people shared the video.”

「這麼多人分享她的影片，令她感到**很受肯定**。」

8. **be flattered to + verb = 很榮幸 / 很受寵若驚能.....**

Practice 15

> “I’m **flattered to be invited**.”

「獲邀令我感到**很榮幸 / 受寵若驚**。」

Practice 16

> “She was flattered to hear that people admired her work.”

「聽到大家欣賞她的作品，她感到**很受肯定**。」

E. FLATTERING — CAUSING PLEASURE THROUGH PRAISE

9. **flattering = pleasing because it shows admiration — 令人受寵若驚的；令人感到受肯定的**

This is your exact source branch.

Practice 17 — Original

> “It was **flattering** to know that so many strangers enjoyed the video.”

「知道這麼多陌生人都喜歡這段影片，確實**令人很受肯定**。」

Practice 18

> “It was flattering to be chosen for the award.”

「被選中獲獎令人感到**很受寵若驚**。」

flattering = 因顯示別人欣賞、肯定、重視自己而令人高興的

F. FLATTERING REMARK / COMPLIMENT

10. **flattering remark/comment** = 恭維話；令人高興的稱讚

Practice 19

> “He made a few **flattering remarks** about her work.”

「他對她的作品說了幾句**好聽的稱讚話**。」

Practice 20

> “The review contained several flattering comments.”

「那篇評論中有幾句**很正面的評語**。」

Important:

flattering comment may be:

* sincere praise

* overly complimentary

Context decides.

G. FLATTERING ATTENTION

11. **flattering attention** = 令人感到受重視的關注

Practice 21

> “She enjoyed the ****flattering attention**** at first.”

「起初，她很享受那種****令人感到受重視的關注****。」

Practice 22

> “The sudden attention was flattering but overwhelming.”

「突如其來的關注令人****受寵若驚****，但也讓人吃不消。」

This is especially relevant to your passage.

H. “I’M FLATTERED, BUT...”

12. ****I’m flattered, but... = 我很受寵若驚，不過.....****

A very common polite rejection formula.

Practice 23

> “I’m ****flattered****, but I can’t accept the offer.”

「我真的****很受寵若驚****，不過我不能接受這個提議。」

Practice 24

> “I’m flattered, but I’m not interested in dating.”

「你的心意令我****很受寵若驚****，但我沒有興趣約會。」

****I’m flattered, but... = 先表示感謝 / 受重視，再禮貌拒絕****

Very useful conversational English.

I. FLATTER YOURSELF

13. ****flatter yourself = 過度自信；把自己想得太重要 / 太好****

A very important idiom.

Practice 25

> “Don’t **flatter yourself** — I wasn’t talking about you.”

「別**自作多情 / 把自己想得太重要**，我不是在說你。」

Practice 26

> “He flatters himself that everyone admires him.”

「他**自以為**人人都欣賞他。」

flatter yourself = 對自己的重要性、魅力、能力等有過高評價

14. **flatter oneself that + clause = 自以為.....**

Formal/literary.

Practice 27

> “She **flattered herself that** she could solve the problem alone.”

「她**自以為**自己能獨力解決問題。」

Practice 28

> “He flattered himself that the audience had come just to see him.”

「他**自以為**觀眾都是專程來看他的。」

J. “YOU FLATTER ME”

15. **You flatter me. = 你過獎了；你太抬舉我了**

A fixed conversational response.

Practice 29

> “You’re the best speaker here.”

> “**You flatter me.**”

「你是這裡最好的講者。」

「你**過獎了**。」

Practice 30

> “You flatter me, but thank you.”

「你太**抬舉我了**，不過謝謝你。」

Can be:

* sincere modesty

* playful

* ironic

K. CLOTHING / APPEARANCE

16. **flatter someone = make someone look attractive — 令某人顯得更好看；襯托某人**

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 31

> “That colour really **flatters you**.”

「那個顏色真的很**襯你 / 令你更好看**。」

Practice 32

> “The dress flatters her figure.”

「這條裙很**襯她的身形**。」

flatter — appearance = 衣服、顏色、款式等令人的外貌 / 身形看起來更好

This is a genuinely separate common sense.

17. **flatter someone's figure = 修飾 / 襯托身形**

Practice 33

> “The cut is designed to **flatter the figure**.”

「這個剪裁設計是為了**修飾身形**。」

Practice 34

> “The jacket flatters his shoulders.”

「這件外套很**襯他的肩膀線條**。」

L. FLATTERING CLOTHES

18. **flattering = making someone look attractive — 顯瘦 / 修飾身形的；襯人的；好看的**

Practice 35

> “That dress is very **flattering**.”

「那條裙非常**襯你 / 很修飾身形**。」

Practice 36

> “The jacket has a flattering shape.”

「這件外套的版型很**修飾身形**。」

flattering — fashion = 令穿著者外貌 / 身形看起來更理想的

19. **flattering fit/cut = 修飾身形的版型 / 剪裁**

Practice 37

> “The trousers have a **flattering fit**.”

「這條褲子的版型很**修飾身形**。」

Practice 38

> “The flattering cut makes the jacket look elegant.”

「這種**修飾身形的剪裁**令外套更優雅。」

M. COLOUR

20. **flattering colour = 襯膚色 / 襯人的顏色**

Practice 39

> “Blue is a very **flattering colour** on you.”

「藍色非常**襯你的膚色**。」

Practice 40

> “The stylist chose colours that flatter her complexion.”

「造型師選了幾種能**襯托她膚色**的顏色。」

N. HAIRSTYLE / MAKEUP

21. **flattering hairstyle = 襯臉型的髮型**

Practice 41

> “The shorter haircut is more **flattering**.”

「較短的髮型更**襯她的臉型**。」

Practice 42

> “She chose a flattering hairstyle for the event.”

「她為活動選了一個很**襯臉型的髮型**。」

22. **flattering makeup = 能修飾外貌的妝容**

Practice 43

> “The makeup is natural and **flattering**.”

「這個妝容自然，而且很**襯人**。」

Practice 44

> “Soft makeup can be more flattering in daylight.”

「柔和的妝容在日光下可能更**好看 / 自然**。」

O. PHOTOGRAPHY

23. **flattering photo = 把人拍得好看的照片**

Practice 45

> “That’s a very **flattering photo** of you.”

「那張照片把你**拍得很好看**。」

Practice 46

> “She chose the most flattering photo for her profile.”

「她選了最**上鏡 / 最把自己拍得好看**的照片作頭像。」

flattering photo = 令人看起來比平常更吸引 / 更理想的照片

24. **flattering angle = 好看的拍攝角度；修飾外貌的角度**

Practice 47

> “The photographer found a more **flattering angle**.”

「攝影師找到一個更**好看的拍攝角度**。」

Practice 48

> “That angle is not very flattering.”

「那個角度拍起來不太**好看**。」

P. LIGHTING

25. **flattering light/lighting = 令人看起來更好看的光線**

Practice 49

> “Soft light is usually more **flattering**.”

「柔和光線通常比較**襯人**。」

Practice 50

> “The restaurant uses warm, flattering lighting.”

「餐廳使用溫暖而**令人看起來更好看的燈光**。」

flattering lighting = 能減少瑕疵、改善膚色 / 輪廓視覺效果的光線

Q. MIRROR / IMAGE

26. flattering mirror/image = 使外觀看起來更理想的鏡像 / 影像

Practice 51

> “The mirror gives a surprisingly **flattering reflection**.”

「這面鏡子的倒影竟然把人照得**很好看**。」

Practice 52

> “The image was flattering but not entirely realistic.”

「那張影像把人拍得很好看，但不完全真實。」

R. DESCRIPTION / PORTRAYAL

27. flattering description/portrait = 美化性的描述；有利的描寫

A broader figurative extension from appearance.

Practice 53

> “The biography gives a very **flattering portrait** of its subject.”

「這本傳記對主人公作出了非常**正面的 / 美化性的描寫**。」

Practice 54

> “The report presents a flattering picture of the company.”

「報告對公司作出了相當**有利 / 美化的描述**。」

flattering portrayal = 把某人 / 某事呈現得比實際更正面、更吸引

S. UNFLATTERING

28. **unflattering = 令人顯得不好看的；不討好的；負面的**

A very useful opposite.

Practice 55

> “The photo is rather **unflattering**.”

「那張照片把他拍得不太**好看**。」

Practice 56

> “The article presents an unflattering picture of the industry.”

「文章對這個行業作出了相當**負面的描述**。」

unflattering = 令外貌 / 形象 / 評價顯得較差的

29. **unflattering comparison = 對某人不利的比較**

Practice 57

> “The report makes an **unflattering comparison** with competitors.”

「報告作出了一個對該公司**不利的比較**。」

Practice 58

> “The statistics invite an unflattering comparison with last year.”

「這些統計數字令人自然把今年與去年作出一個**不太有利的比較**。」

T. DATA / STATISTICS

30. **flatter the figures/results = 令數字看起來比實際更好；美化數據**

A major business/journalistic sense.

Practice 59

> “Temporary sales may have **flattered the figures**.”

「短期銷售可能令數字看起來**比實際情況更好**。」

Practice 60

> “One large order flattered the quarterly results.”

「一張大型訂單**美化了季度業績**。」

flatter figures/results = 因特殊 / 暫時因素令表面數據顯得過度正面

This is highly useful business English.

31. **flatter performance = 使表現看起來優於實際**

Practice 61

> “The easy comparison base **flattered performance**.”

「較低的比較基數令表現看起來**比實際更佳**。」

Practice 62

> “Exchange-rate movements flattered reported growth.”

「匯率變動令公布的增長數字顯得**較實際更亮麗**。」

U. RESULTS / STATISTICS THAT FLATTER TO DECEIVE

32. **figures flatter to deceive = 數字看似很好，但實際未必如此**

A common phrase especially in sport/business commentary.

Practice 63

> “The headline numbers **flatter to deceive**.”

「表面數字**看起來很亮麗，但其實有誤導性**。」

Practice 64

> “Their possession statistics flattered to deceive.”

「他們的控球數據**看似漂亮，實際卻沒有反映真正優勢**。」

flatter to deceive = 表面令人印象很好，但深入看並沒有那麼理想

V. SPORT

33. **scoreline flatters a team** = 比數令某隊看起來表現比實際好

A common sports-journalism use.

Practice 65

> “The 3–0 scoreline **flattered** the winners.”

「3 比 0 的比數令勝方看起來**比實際表現更佔優**。」

Practice 66

> “The final score flattered the home side.”

「最終比數**美化了主隊實際表現**。」

the score flatters X = 比數沒有完全反映場上實況，令 X 顯得比實際更好

34. **scoreline flatters to deceive** = 比數漂亮但表現不實在

Practice 67

> “The scoreline flattered to deceive.”

「比數看起來很漂亮，**但沒有反映真正表現**。」

Practice 68

> “Their statistics flattered to deceive throughout the season.”

「他們整季的數據**表面亮麗，實際說服力不足**。」

W. “FLATTERING YOUR EGO”

35. **flatter someone's ego = 滿足某人的自尊 / 虛榮心**

Practice 69

> “The attention **flattered his ego**.”

「這些關注**滿足了他的虛榮心 / 自尊心**。」

Practice 70

> “Compliments can flatter the ego without building real confidence.”

「稱讚可以**滿足虛榮心**，但未必能建立真正的自信。」

Very relevant to your passage's theme.

X. “FLATTER SOMEONE INTO DOING SOMETHING”

36. **flatter someone into doing something = 用奉承誘使某人做某事**

A useful construction.

Practice 71

> “They **flattered him into accepting** the role.”

「他們用奉承的方式**哄他接受了**這個角色。」

Practice 72

> “She flattered him into paying for dinner.”

「她用恭維話**哄得他付了晚餐費**。」

flatter someone into X = 利用稱讚 / 奉承影響某人，使其做某事

Y. "FLATTER SOMEONE WITH..."

37. **flatter someone with compliments/praise = 用讚美討好某人**

Practice 73

> "He **flattered her with compliments**."

「他用一堆稱讚話**討好她**。」

Practice 74

> "They tried to flatter the client with praise."

「他們試圖用讚美**奉承客戶**。」

Z. "BE FLATTERED INTO..."

38. **be flattered into doing something = 因受奉承而被哄去做某事**

Practice 75

> "He was **flattered into agreeing**."

「他因受到奉承而**被哄得同意了**。」

Practice 76

> "She was flattered into taking on more work."

「她因別人的恭維而**被哄得接下更多工作**。」

AA. "FLATTERY WILL GET YOU EVERYWHERE"

39. **Flattery will get you everywhere. = 會奉承人就好辦事；你這樣誇我很有用啊**

A humorous fixed expression.

Practice 77

> “You look younger every day.”

> “**Flattery will get you everywhere.**”

「你一天比一天年輕。」

「哈哈，**你這樣誇我可真會討好人。**」

Practice 78

> “Flattery will get you everywhere, but I still won’t change the deadline.”

「你這麼會恭維也沒用，我還是不會改截止日期。」

Usually humorous, not literal advice.

AB. “IMITATION IS THE SINCEREST FORM OF FLATTERY”

40. **imitation is the sincerest form of flattery = 模仿是最真誠的讚美**

A famous fixed saying.

Practice 79

> “He copied your style? Well, imitation is the sincerest form of flattery.”

「他模仿你的風格？那也可以說**模仿是最真誠的讚美**。」

Practice 80

> “She treated the imitation as a form of flattery.”

「她把這種模仿視為一種**讚美**。」

Meaning:

> copying someone may show admiration.

AC. “FALSE FLATTERY”

41. **false flattery = 虛假的奉承**

Practice 81

> “She could immediately recognise **false flattery**.”

「她立即看得出那是**虛假奉承**。」

Practice 82

> “False flattery can damage trust.”

「**虛假的恭維**可能損害信任。」

AD. “EMPTY FLATTERY”

42. **empty flattery = 空洞奉承；沒有實質內容的讚美**

Practice 83

> “He preferred honest feedback to **empty flattery**.”

「比起**空洞的奉承**，他更喜歡坦誠回饋。」

Practice 84

> “The speech was full of empty flattery.”

「演說充滿**空泛的恭維話**。」

AE. “SHAMELESS FLATTERY”

43. **shameless flattery = 厚顏奉承；赤裸裸拍馬屁**

Practice 85

> “Everyone noticed his **shameless flattery** of the boss.”

「大家都注意到他對老闆那種**明目張膽的奉承**。」

Practice 86

> “The compliment sounded like shameless flattery.”

「那句稱讚聽起來像是**赤裸裸的拍馬屁**。」

AF. FLATTERING TONE

44. **flattering tone = 奉承 / 恭維的語氣**

Practice 87

> “He spoke in a **flattering tone**.”

「他用一種**奉承的語氣**說話。」

Practice 88

> “Her flattering tone made the compliment sound insincere.”

「她那種**過分恭維的語氣**令稱讚聽起來不真誠。」

AG. FLATTERING REVIEW

45. **flattering review = 高度正面的評論；過於美化的評論**

Practice 89

> “The restaurant received a **flattering review**.”

「那間餐廳收到一篇非常**正面的評論**。」

Practice 90

> “The biography received criticism for being too flattering.”

「這本傳記因寫得太過**美化主人公**而受到批評。」

AH. FLATTERING COMPARISON

46. **flattering comparison = 對某人有利的比較**

Practice 91

> “The article drew a **flattering comparison** between the young player and a champion.”

「文章把這名年輕球員與冠軍相比，這是一個對他非常**有利 / 抬舉的比較**。」

Practice 92

> “Being compared with such an expert was flattering.”

「被拿來跟這樣的專家相比，實在令人**受寵若驚**。」

AI. “IT FLATTERS YOU”

47. **It flatters you.** = 它很襯你；令你看起來更好看

Practice 93

> “That jacket really **flatters you**.”

「那件外套真的**很襯你**。」

Practice 94

> “This hairstyle flatters you more.”

「這個髮型**更襯你**。」

This has nothing to do with verbal praise.

AJ. “THE CAMERA DOESN’T FLATTER...”

48. **camera/photo does not flatter someone** = 鏡頭 / 照片沒有把人拍得好看

Practice 95

> “The camera doesn’t always **flatter** him.”

「鏡頭未必總能把他**拍得好看**。」

Practice 96

> “That photograph doesn’t flatter her.”

「那張照片沒有把她**拍得好看**。」

AK. “FLATTERING LIGHT” VS “HARSH LIGHT”

49. **flattering light vs harsh light**

flattering light

= soft light that improves appearance

harsh light

= strong light that emphasizes texture/shadows

Practice 97

> “Soft window light is more flattering than harsh overhead light.”

「柔和的窗邊光線比強烈的頂燈更**襯人**。」

Practice 98

> “Harsh lighting can make skin texture more obvious.”

「強烈光線會令皮膚紋理更明顯。」

AL. FLATTERINGLY

50. **flatteringly = in a way that makes someone/something look good — 以襯托 / 美化的方式**

Relatively uncommon.

Practice 99

> “The dress falls **flatteringly** around the waist.”

「這條裙在腰部的剪裁**很修飾身形**。」

Practice 100

> “The portrait presents him flatteringly.”

「這幅肖像把他描繪得**相當討好 / 好看**。」

Register:

* less common

* often fashion/writing

AM. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

flatter vs compliment

compliment

= give someone praise.

flatter

= praise someone in a way that pleases them; often implies exaggeration or self-interest.

Compare:

> “She complimented me on my presentation.”

> = 她稱讚了我的簡報。

> “She flattered me by saying I was the best speaker there.”

> = 她恭維我，說我是全場最好的講者。

Flatter carries more risk of:

> exaggeration / manipulation.

flattery vs compliment

a compliment

= one expression of praise.

flattery

= praise as a behaviour/style, often excessive or insincere.

> a compliment

> = 一句稱讚

> flattery

> = 奉承 / 恭維

flatter vs praise

praise

= openly express approval or admiration.

flatter

= say things specifically likely to please the person, sometimes for ulterior motives.

> praise excellent work

> = 讚揚好作品

> flatter the boss

> = 奉承老闆

Praise is generally more neutral/sincere.

flatter vs admire

admire

= genuinely think highly of someone/something.

flatter

= express praise to the person.

You can admire someone silently.

To flatter normally involves:

> expression / treatment that makes them feel admired.

flatter vs please

please

= make someone happy/satisfied.

flatter

= make someone pleased specifically because they feel admired, valued, or attractive.

So:

> flattering is a special kind of pleasing.

flattered vs pleased

pleased

= generally happy/satisfied.

flattered

= pleased specifically because someone has:

- * praised you
- * noticed you
- * chosen you
- * admired you
- * valued your opinion

Example:

> “I’m pleased the project worked.”

> = 我很高興項目成功。

> “I’m flattered they asked me to lead it.”

> = 他們找我帶領項目，令我很受寵若驚。

flattered vs honoured

flattered

= personally pleased by admiration/attention.

honoured

= feel deeply privileged/respected by an important invitation/recognition.

> flattered by a compliment

> = 因稱讚而受寵若驚

> honoured to receive an award

> = 獲獎深感榮幸

They overlap, but **honoured** is usually more formal/serious.

flattered vs proud

flattered

= positive feeling caused by others' admiration.

proud

= positive feeling about one's own achievement/identity or someone else's.

> flattered by their praise

> = 因別人的讚賞而受寵若驚

> proud of my work

> = 為自己的作品感到自豪

flattered vs validated

flattered

= pleased by praise/attention.

validated

= feel that one's feelings, identity, experience, or judgement has been confirmed as legitimate.

Social-media attention can feel:

- * flattering
- * validating

but they are not identical.

****flattering vs complimentary****

****flattering****

can mean:

1. praising/admiring
2. making someone look attractive

****complimentary****

can mean:

1. expressing praise
2. free of charge

Example:

> flattering review
> = 很正面的評論

> complimentary review
> = 讚賞性的評論

but:

> complimentary drink
> = 免費飲品

****Flattering**** never means “free”.

****flattering vs attractive****

****attractive****

= inherently visually appealing.

flattering

= makes *the wearer/person* look better.

> attractive dress

> = 裙本身漂亮

> flattering dress

> = 裙穿在人身上很襯人

Excellent fashion distinction.

flattering vs slimming

slimming

= specifically makes someone appear thinner.

flattering

= broader: may improve proportions, colour, face shape, skin tone, etc.

So:

> slimming is one possible kind of flattering.

flattering vs photogenic

photogenic

= tends to look attractive in photographs.

flattering photo

= this particular photo makes the subject look good.

> photogenic person

> = 上鏡的人

> flattering photograph
> = 把人拍得好看的照片

****flattering vs accurate****

A very important contrast.

Something can be flattering but inaccurate.

> “The portrait is flattering.”

may imply:

> it presents the person more favourably than reality.

So:

> flattering ≠ objective.

****flattering vs favourable****

****favourable****

= positive/advantageous in evaluation.

****flattering****

= positive in a way that makes someone/something look especially good.

> favourable report

> = 正面報告

> flattering report

> = 把對象寫得特別好看的報告

****Flattering**** often suggests stronger positive presentation.

****flattering vs misleading****

In data contexts:

A number may be:

> flattering

because it makes performance look better.

If it creates a false impression, it may also be:

> misleading.

But flattering does not automatically mean deliberately deceptive.

****flattering figures vs manipulated figures****

****flattering figures****

= figures look unusually positive, perhaps because of temporary/contextual factors.

****manipulated figures****

= figures were deliberately altered/distorted.

Huge difference.

Example:

> favourable exchange rates can flatter revenue

without anyone manipulating the data.

****flatter the figures vs improve the figures****

****improve the figures****

= actual performance/numbers become better.

****flatter the figures****

= the presentation/context makes them look better than underlying reality.

Excellent business-English distinction.

flatter to deceive

This does not mean literally:

> 奉承某人來欺騙他。

As an idiom:

> **look impressive at first but prove less good/effective than expected**

Chinese:

> **表面亮麗，實際未如理想**

flatter yourself vs be confident

be confident

= believe reasonably in your ability/value.

flatter yourself

= overestimate your importance, attractiveness, ability, influence, etc.

So:

> confidence = can be justified

> flattering yourself = usually implies self-deception/arrogance

flatter yourself vs fool yourself

fool yourself

= believe something false generally.

flatter yourself

= believe something unrealistically positive specifically about yourself.

Example:

> “Don’t flatter yourself. She wasn’t looking at you.”

= 別自作多情，她不是在看你。

“You flatter me” vs “I’m flattered”

You flatter me.

focuses on:

> the other person giving praise

= 你過獎了。

I’m flattered.

focuses on:

> your emotional reaction

= 我很受寵若驚。

flattering — praise vs appearance

A crucial polysemy contrast.

Social:

> “That’s very flattering.”

= 那真令人受寵若驚。

Fashion:

> “That dress is very flattering.”

= 那條裙很襯你。

Same adjective, different Chinese.

flatter — social vs visual

Social:

> “He flattered her.”

= 他奉承 / 恭維她。

Visual:

> “The dress flatters her.”

= 那條裙很襯她。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

flattering — praise vs data

Praise:

> “The article was flattering.”

= 文章把對方寫得很好 / 很正面。

Data:

> “The quarterly numbers were flattering.”

= 季度數字看起來比基本情況更好。

The shared concept is:

> **presenting someone/something in a more favourable light**

flattery vs approval

You have already curated **approval**.

approval

= positive judgement/acceptance.

flattery

= praise directed at someone, often designed to make them feel good.

You can approve of someone silently.

Flattery normally requires:

> expressed praise or favourable treatment.

flattery vs recognition

recognition

= being noticed/acknowledged.

flattery

= praise/attention that positively boosts self-image.

In your passage:

> viral attention created recognition

and the positive reaction felt:

> flattering.

flattery vs validation

validation

= confirmation that one's feelings/identity/value are legitimate.

flattery

= admiration/praise, possibly exaggerated.

Validation can be sincere and emotionally supportive without complimenting someone.

flattery vs sycophancy

flattery

= praise intended to please, possibly insincere.

sycophancy

= excessive servile flattery toward powerful people for advantage.

Chinese:

* flattery = 奉承 / 恭維

* sycophancy = 阿諛奉承 / 諂媚

Sycophancy is stronger and more negative.

flatter vs suck up to

flatter

= standard verb.

suck up to

= informal, clearly negative:

> 拍馬屁 / 巴結

> “He’s sucking up to the boss.”

is harsher than:

> “He’s flattering the boss.”

flatter vs butter someone up

butter someone up

= use praise/charm specifically to make them cooperative.

Informal.

> flatter someone

> = 奉承某人

> butter someone up

> = 用好話哄某人，好讓他答應某事

flatter vs charm

charm

= attract/please through personality or behaviour.

flatter

= please through admiration/praise.

Someone can charm without directly praising.

flatter in your passage

Your sentence:

> “At first, the experience felt almost magical. It was **flattering** to know that something I had created in my bedroom could make so many strangers laugh.”

Here **flattering** does **not** mean:

- * insincere praise,
- * clothes that improve appearance,
- * flattering statistics,
- * self-deception.

It means:

> **the positive attention made the writer feel pleased, appreciated, and personally affirmed.**

The writer is not saying the strangers were deliberately “buttering me up”.

Instead:

> **their response itself was flattering because it showed that something the writer created mattered to other people.**

Family-extension sweep

Following the fullest-reference style, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **flatter someone — praise** = 稱讚 / 恭維某人
- * **flatter someone — insincere** = 奉承 / 拍馬屁
- * **flattery** = 奉承 / 恭維
- * **be flattered** = 感到受寵若驚 / 受肯定
- * **be flattered by** = 因……而感到受寵若驚
- * **be flattered that** = 因……而感到受肯定
- * **be flattered to do** = 很榮幸 / 受寵若驚能……
- * **flattering — praise** = 令人受寵若驚的
- * **flattering remark** = 恭維 / 正面稱讚
- * **flattering attention** = 令人感到受重視的關注
- * **I'm flattered, but…** = 我很受寵若驚，不過……
- * **flatter yourself** = 自作多情 / 過度高估自己
- * **flatter oneself that** = 自以為……
- * **You flatter me** = 你過獎了 / 太抬舉我了
- * **flatter someone — appearance** = 令某人看起來更好看
- * **flatter the figure** = 修飾身形
- * **flattering clothes** = 襯人的 / 修飾身形的衣服
- * **flattering colour** = 襯膚色的顏色
- * **flattering hairstyle** = 襯臉型的髮型
- * **flattering photo** = 把人拍得好看的照片
- * **flattering angle** = 好看的拍攝角度
- * **flattering lighting** = 令人看起來更好看的光線
- * **flattering portrayal** = 美化性的描寫
- * **unflattering** = 不討好 / 令人顯得不好看的
- * **unflattering comparison** = 不利的比較
- * **flatter the figures** = 令數據看起來較實際更好
- * **flatter performance** = 美化表現
- * **flatter to deceive** = 表面亮麗但實際未如理想
- * **scoreline flatters a team** = 比數令球隊看起來比實際更好
- * **flatter someone's ego** = 滿足某人的虛榮心
- * **flatter someone into doing** = 用奉承哄某人做某事
- * **be flattered into doing** = 因受奉承而被哄去做某事
- * **false flattery** = 虛假奉承
- * **empty flattery** = 空洞奉承
- * **shameless flattery** = 明目張膽的奉承
- * **flattering review** = 高度正面 / 美化性的評論

* **flattering comparison** = 對某人有利、抬舉人的比較

* **flatteringly** = 以襯托 / 美化方式

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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flatter someone — general	用讚美 / 恭維令某人感到高興或受到重視
flatter someone — insincere	為討好或獲取好處而給某人過度 / 不真誠的讚美
flattery	通常帶討好或誇張成分的讚美 / 奉承
be flattered	因別人的讚賞、重視、邀請或關注而感到受寵若驚
flattering — emotional	顯示別人欣賞 / 重視自己，因而令人感到受肯定的
I'm flattered, but...	先表示受到重視 / 讚賞，再禮貌拒絕
flatter yourself	對自己的重要性、吸引力或能力有過高估計
flatter someone — appearance	令某人的外貌、膚色或身形看起來更理想
flattering clothes	穿起來能改善 / 修飾外觀或身形的衣服
flattering colour	能襯托某人膚色 / 外貌的顏色
flattering photograph	把人物拍得比平常更好看的照片
flattering angle	能令人物在照片 / 影片中看起來更理想的角度
flattering lighting	能改善人物視覺效果、減少瑕疵感的光線
flattering portrayal	將某人 / 某事呈現得特別正面或比實際更好的描述
unflattering	令外貌 / 形象 / 評價顯得較差或不利的
flatter the figures/results	因特殊因素令數據表面看起來比實際基本表現更好
flatter to deceive	表面看起來很出色，但深入看實際未如理想
scoreline flatters X	比數令某隊的實際表現看起來比場面上更好
flatter someone's ego	透過讚美或關注滿足某人的自尊 / 虛榮心
flatter someone into doing	利用讚美或奉承影響某人，使其答應做某事
flatteringly	以令某人 / 某事看起來更有利、更吸引的方式

For your original sentence

> “At first, the experience felt almost magical. It was **flattering** to know that something I had created in my bedroom could make so many strangers laugh.”

The exact meaning is:

flattering = 作者發現自己隨手創作的影片竟然得到大量陌生人的正面反應，這令他覺得自己的創意受到欣賞、重視和肯定，因此感到非常高興和受寵若驚。 **

Natural translation:

> **「起初，這種經歷幾乎像魔法一樣。想到自己在房間裡創作的東西竟然能逗笑這麼多陌生人，確實令人感到很受肯定、甚至有點受寵若驚。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****flatter someone**** → 稱讚 / 奉承某人
- > ****flattery**** → 奉承 / 恭維
- > ****be flattered**** → 感到受寵若驚
- > ****I'm flattered**** → 我很受寵若驚
- > ****flatter yourself**** → 自作多情 / 過度高估自己
- > ****flattering dress**** → 很襯人 / 修飾身形的裙
- > ****flattering colour**** → 襯膚色的顏色
- > ****flattering photo**** → 把人拍得好看的照片
- > ****unflattering photo**** → 把人拍得不好看的照片
- > ****flatter the figures**** → 令數據看起來較實際更好
- > ****flatter to deceive**** → 表面亮麗但實際未如理想
- > ****flatter vs compliment**** → 令人高興的恭維 / 可能誇張 vs 一般稱讚
- > ****flattering ≠ necessarily insincere**** → 令人受肯定 ≠ 必然虛假奉承